

Optimisation landscape

Problem /Method	Algorithm Family	Software package ^[1] Opensource Commercial	Optimization reach Optimization-only Decision-integrated	Characteristics
1. MILP - Single/multi objectives - Linear objective functions - (Conflicting) objectives - Mixed-integer variables - Feasibility constraints	Exact/ linear programming (LP) : Simplex and/or Branch-and-Bound (-Cut). MOO via different methods, e.g.: WAM performance aggregation + (optional) Pareto-weights; ϵ -constraint ; distance-based formulation (ideal-point).	ORTools, HiGHS, SCIP, CBC, Choco-solver Gurobi, CPLEX, COPT, FICO Xpress	MOO : multi-objective optimisation for performance. Requires a-posteriori MCDA for evaluation; no direct best-fit	Highly scalable and fast. Strictly linear structure $\Rightarrow$ global optimality guaranteed. Often not suitable for complex real-world engineering and scheduling problems. Mainly suitable for teaching and introductory use.
2. MINLP (MIP) - Single/multi objectives - Non-linear objective functions - (Conflicting) objectives - Mixed-integer variables - Feasibility constraints	Quasi-exact/ constraint programming (CP) : decomposition-based ; specific hybrid or transformed MILPs.	ORTools, SCIP BARON, AntiGone, Gurobi*, CPLEX*	MOO : multi-objective optimisation for performance. Requires a-posteriori MCDA for evaluation; no direct best-fit	Rigid; problem-class specific; requires exact math formulation. Guarantees objective optimality, but not decision-best-fit.
	Evolutionary / Pareto heuristics : Genetic Algorithms: e.g., NSGA-II, MOEA/D, SPEA, BRKGA.	Pymoo, DEAP	MOO : multi-objective Pareto optimality. Requires a-posteriori MCDA for evaluation; no direct best-fit	Black-box; Pareto methods cover only part of real-world problems. No guarantee of decision-best-fit (dominance in objective space only).
3. IMAP - Single/multi performance - (Non)-linear system performance functions - (Non)-monotonic multi-actor preference functions - (Conflicting) preferences - All type of variables - Feasibility & acceptability constraints	Intergenerational / Preference-based : Population based metaheuristic: IMAP-IGS (instantiations: IGS-GA I, IGS-GA II IGS-BRKGA, IGS-SI).	PREFERENDUS	MODO : multi-objective design/decision optimisation, Directly solves for ‘best-fit’ design-decision point; pure support for multi-criteria design & decision-making (MCDM)	Design/decision-valid: integrates performance and preferences. Preferences explicitly modeled from performance and/or attributes. Yields a best-fit solution in aggregated weighted-preference design-decision space. Flexible for highly constrained, multi-actor real-world problems (incl. preference-based constraint handling). Also able to solve (non)linear SODOs.

[1] Among the most relevant

* Limited (mainly quadratic)